

A key feature is Microsoft's 'just-in-time UI' model, which dynamically generates interfaces based on user intent, context, and device type. Rather than relying on fixed layouts, the same task can produce different outputs on a wearable device and a larger display, potentially reducing the need for developers to create multiple screen-specific interfaces.



Microsoft also showcased two reference designs: a wearable badge featuring a touchscreen, camera, microphone array, and biometric authentication, and a desk companion device that can function as a cloud PC client when connected to an external display. Notably, Solara-powered devices do not feature traditional applications, app stores, or desktop interfaces.

The platform remains in an early stage, with pilot deployments reportedly underway at Best Buy, CVS Health, Levi's, and Target.

European Commission proposes open source-first approach for public sector cloud and AI software procurement

The European Commission has unveiled a sweeping technological sovereignty package that places open source at the centre of its efforts to reduce dependence on foreign technology providers and strengthen Europe's control over critical digital infrastructure.



At the heart of the proposal is the Cloud and AI Development Act (CADA), which would require public administrations to give preference to open source solutions when procuring cloud and AI software. The move elevates open source from an alternative option to a strategic procurement priority across the European public sector.

The package also introduces a dedicated open source strategy focused on expanding open source adoption in government, improving interoperability between public digital systems, supporting the long-term maintenance and security of open source infrastructure, and fostering open digital ecosystems.

The Commission noted that the EU currently spends €264 billion annually on non-European proprietary software and aims to reduce this dependence by encouraging open ecosystems and European alternatives. Examples highlighted include EUDI Wallet and Mastodon.

Under CADA, member states would be required to conduct sovereignty risk assessments covering digital service control, supply chains, AI data processing, infrastructure location, and cybersecurity. The legislation also seeks to curb 'sovereignty washing,' where foreign cloud providers market services as independent European offerings through intermediaries. In sensitive sectors such as defence and critical infrastructure, authorities could be required to use European software and hardware, while €180 million in services would be directed towards trusted EU partners.

"Europe cannot afford to be dependent on others for critical technologies for hospitals, energy grids, and security services," said Ursula von der Leyen, president of the European Commission.

US Senator defends CLARITY Act

Senator Cynthia Lummis has defended protections for open source software developers in the CLARITY Act, arguing that developers who create code for

Microsoft opens WinUI development to public repositories

Microsoft has announced a major expansion of its open source strategy for WinUI, moving the Windows UI framework towards more transparent, community-driven development as it rewrites key Windows 11 components in native code.

The company said WinUI has reached 'Phase 3' of its open source journey, allowing developers to build, test and validate changes publicly. Microsoft's next goal, 'Phase 4', would see development occur primarily in public repositories, enabling external contributors to track changes, submit fixes and help shape the framework's future.

Microsoft has also introduced Microsoft UI Reactor, an experimental open source, C#-first declarative UI framework designed to simplify native WinUI application development. The project removes dependencies on XAML, data binding and view models while introducing modern concepts such as hooks, state management and flex layouts. Successful innovations from Reactor are expected to migrate into production WinUI.

The open source push accompanies Microsoft's broader effort to rebuild Windows 11 around native technologies. Core shell components, including parts of the Start menu currently powered by React Native, are being rewritten using WinUI to improve responsiveness, reduce RAM and CPU usage, and enhance overall performance.

"We've started to integrate it into the shell at a much faster rate. And so you're going to see a lot of the first-party features coming from Microsoft being built on top of WinUI," said Chris Anderson, vice president of software engineering at Microsoft.

Microsoft has also dropped the '3' from WinUI 3, reaffirming WinUI as its long-term native application platform with no plans for a future WinUI 4 framework.